ELASTIC{ON} NEW YORK · OCT 8, 2026

Two buyers. One platform. Opposite reasons.

How two regulated financial firms bought their security data platform, stage by stage, from their own slides.

New York Life
Sal Picheria · Corporate VP, Security Engineering

Vanguard
Jonathan Reitnauer · Head of Cyber Security Detection & Orchestration

THE JOURNEY ON ONE PAGE

Same vendor, different path

	NEW YORK LIFE	VANGUARD
BROKE	Data in, but slow and costly to get out	Alerts outgrew a team it couldn't hire for
REFRAME	A platform for the whole security org	Handlers become decision-makers
CHOSE	A mature schema	An AI roadmap and a co-builder
BUILT	6-month cutover, onboarding as code	Automation on every alert
NEXT	Federated search	Federated search + AI that executes

Source: speakers' slides and talks, Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026.

Data lake or SIEM? Neither.

	DATA LAKES	SIEMS
Data model	− No mature standard	~ Maturity varies
Analytics	+ Essentially limitless	− Not built for freeform
Rules	—	+ Optimized for rules
Ease of use	− High bar, SQL-style	—
Retention	+ Low-cost	− Costly
Deployment	− One cloud & region	− One cloud & region
Portability	—	− Data hard to get out
Pricing	− Unpredictable	~ Mostly ingest-based

+ Strength ~ Mixed − Trade-off

> *"Neither was a good fit for us on its own." Buying both was vetoed by leadership on cost.*

Source: NYL slide "Data Lake or SIEM?", Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026.

THE CRITERIA

One bought maturity. One bought a roadmap.

NYL · NEEDED

A schema that's been around

1. Robust, stable data model
2. Freeform analytics and rules, in balance
3. Low barrier for non-SOC users
4. Raw and schematized data side by side
5. Deploys across our regions and clouds
6. Performance when needed, cost balanced

VANGUARD · WANTED

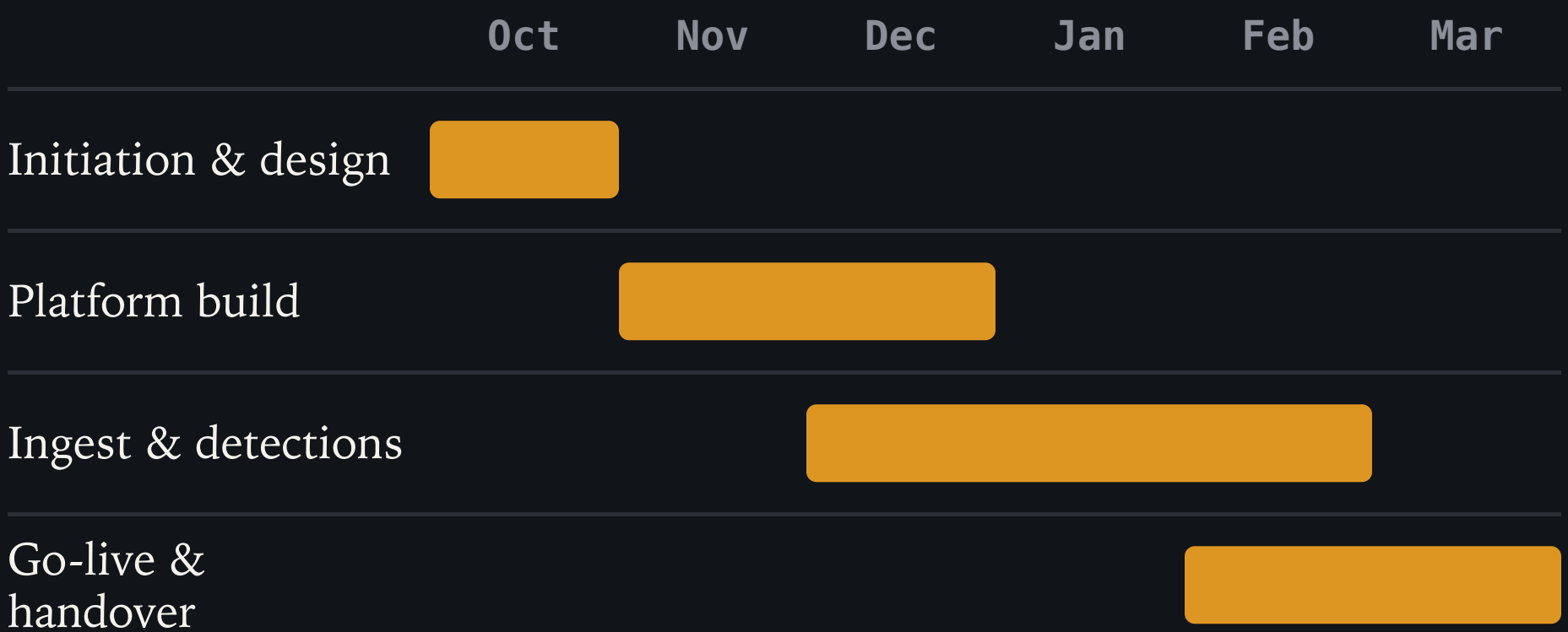
A partner that builds with us

1. Reliability that scales without re-architecting
2. Automation first
3. The AI direction, while still "very, very early"
4. A partner to "take our feedback, and help build it"

Source: NYL slide "What We Needed"; Vanguard keynote, Elastic{ON} New York, Oct 8, 2026.

NYL · THE BUILD

Clusters took minutes. Decisions took months.



Milestones: kickoff Oct · **clusters online end of Dec** · all sources ingested end of Feb · go-live and old SIEM off end of Mar

20–30 min
to spin up a cluster
vs "Clusters online" at month 3

~1 month
running both SIEMs in parallel
IDC mean: 52 days

2 people
from Elastic professional services
IDC median services, 10k+ staff: $1.175M

Sources: NYL slide "The Implementation Journey: 6 Months" + talk; IDC Worldwide Views on SIEM Survey, Jan 2024 (Google-sponsored).

Onboarding as a pull request

1 **Request**
Team opens a ticket

2 **Code**
Team added to Terraform vars

3 **Automate**
Spaces, roles, RBAC and API keys deploy

4 **Access**
SSO groups map to roles

5 **Land**
Team signs in, straight into its own space

20 teams

200 users, in a year

Source: NYL slide "A Paved Road into Elastic". No public benchmark exists for this.

VANGUARD · THE FUTURE SOC

AI executes. Humans govern.

01 · TRUSTED

Data foundation

Identity, endpoint, cloud, network and threat intel in one place

02 · AI POWERED

Execution

Triage, correlation, timelines and response recommendations

03 · GOVERNANCE

Human accountability

Risk decisions, sensitive containment, AI oversight

THE ATTACKERS' VERSION

Anthropic's 2025 espionage disclosure: same shape

80–90%

of the tactical work done by AI

4–6

human decision points per campaign (Anthropic: "perhaps")

Sources: Vanguard slide "The Future SOC: AI Executes, Humans Govern"; Anthropic GTG-1002 report, Nov 2025.

WHERE TO BEGIN

Taking on one of these?

If you're buying

- Price retention as a share of the tool. That's your baseline.
- Decide: a SIEM, or a platform for every security team?
- Run a long POC on your own data. Spend the risk there.
- Put humans at the irreversible step. Log both sides.

If you're selling

- Diagnose maturity buyer vs roadmap buyer first.
- Sell predictable pricing, not cheap pricing.
- Put a decision workshop in the deal.
- Lead AI with governance, not autonomy.

> **Which buyer do you see more: maturity or roadmap?**